

SORTA BOARD OF TRUSTEES MEETING

TUESDAY, FEBRUARY 15TH, 2022 – 6:00 P.M.
SORTA/METRO- HUNTINGTON CENTER
23RD FLOOR CONFERENCE, 525 VINE STREET
CINCINNATI, OHIO 45202

General Items:

Call to order
Pledge of Allegiance
Farwell: Chief Eliot Isaac
Hearings from citizens
Chairman Update

Action Items:

1. Approval of Board Minutes: January 18th, 2022

Finance Committee (*Heidi Black*)

Planning & Operations Committee (*Blake Ethridge*)

Briefing Items:

2. Employee Relations Report (*Adriene Hairston*)
3. Financial Reports for January 2022 (*Cindy Resor*)
4. Metro on the Move (*Darryl Haley*)

Other Items:

New Business

Executive Session: *Section 121.22(G)(4) "Preparing for, conducting, or reviewing negotiations or bargaining sessions with public employees..."*

Adjournment

The next regular meeting of the SORTA Board of Trustees is scheduled for
Tuesday, February 15th, 2022 at 9:00 A.M.

The SORTA Board of Trustees may go into Executive "Closed" Session under the Ohio Open Meetings Act:

Section 121.22(G)(1) To consider appointment, employment, dismissal, discipline, promotion, demotion, or compensation of a public employee...; Section 121.22(G)(2) To consider the purchase of property for public purposes...; Section 121.22(G)(3) Conferences with an attorney for the public body concerning disputes involving the public body that are the subject of pending or imminent court action; Section 121.22(G)(4) Preparing for, conducting, or reviewing negotiations or bargaining sessions with public employees...; Section 121.22(G)(5) Matters required to be kept confidential by federal law or regulations or statutes; Section 121.22(G)(6) Details relative to the security arrangements and emergency response protocols for a public body or a public office; Section 121.22(G)(8) To consider confidential information related to the marketing plans, specific business strategy, production techniques, trade secrets...

BOARD OF TRUSTEES
SOUTHWEST OHIO REGIONAL TRANSIT AUTHORITY

MINUTES OF: Regular Meeting of the SORTA Board of Trustees

DATE: Tuesday, January 18th, 2022 9:00 A.M.

BOARD MEMBERS PRESENT: Alyson Beridon, Heidi Black, Chelsea Clark, Brendon Cull, Kreg Keesee, Roderick Hinton, Gwen Robinson, Sara Sheets, and Sonja Taylor

BOARD MEMBERS ABSENT: Maurice Brown, Blake Ethridge, Allen Freeman, Robert Harris, Thaddeus Hoffmeister, and Larry Thompson

STAFF MEMBERS: Darryl Haley, Donna Adkins, Adriene Hairston, Brandy Jones, Caprice Jones, John Ravasio, Cindy Resor, Shannel Satterfield, and Khaled Shammout

OTHERS: Kim Schafer (Vorys, Sater, Seymour and Pease, LLC)

CALL TO ORDER

Mr. Keesee SORTA Board Vice Chair, called the meeting to order.

PLEDGE OF ALLEGIANCE

The Pledge of Allegiance was recited.

PUBLIC COMMENTS

Tom Carroll: Mr. Carroll of the Village of Silverton thanked Khlaed Shammout for his work and dedication to transit. He asked the Board to consider the resolution on the agenda, in hopes to move the affordable housing project forward in the Village of Silverton.

APPROVAL OF DECEMBER 14TH, 2021 AND JANUARY 7TH, 2022 BOARD MEETING MINUTES

Mr. Keesee made a motion that the minutes of the December 14th, 2021 and January 7th, 2022 board meetings be approved as previously mailed and Mr. Hinton seconded the motion.

By voice vote, the SORTA Board approved the minutes.

FINANCE COMMITTEE

Ms. Black reported the Finance Committee meeting that was held on January 11th, 2022 and there were item(s) to present for Board approval.

Ms. Black moved for adoption and Mr. Keesee seconded the motion to approve action items 2 through 3 on the agenda. By roll call, the SORTA Board approved the Proposed Motion through Resolution No. 2022-02.

PROPOSED MOTION: APPROVAL OF 2022 ANNUAL BOARD MEETING SCHEDULE

This motion approves the 2022 Annual Board Meeting scheduled.

PROPOSED RESOLUTION 2022-02: APPROVAL OF THIRD PARTY ADMINISTRATOR (TPA) CONTRACT FOR WORKERS' COMPENSATION

This resolution approves a five (5) year contract with Hunter Consulting Services Company for third party workers' compensation administration and consulting as the responsible proposer whose proposal is the most advantageous to SORTA, price and other factors considered at a not to exceed cost of \$319,500.

PLANNING AND OPERATIONS COMMITTEE

Mr. Cull reported the Planning and Operations Committee meeting that was held on January 11th, 2022 and there were item(s) to present for Board approval.

Mr. Hinton moved for adoption and Ms. Black seconded the motion to approve action items 4 through 8 on the agenda. By roll call, the SORTA Board approved the Proposed Motion through Resolution No. 2022-06.

PROPOSED MOTION: APPROVAL OF AGENCY SAFETY PLAN

The motion approves the 2022 Agency Safety Plan, procedure number SYS-PGM-0022-R2 and requested authorization for the CEO/General Manager and the Interim Vice President of Safety and Security to implement such plan.

PROPOSED RESOLUTION 2022-03: APPROVAL OF CONTRACT FOR OPERATOR UNIFORMS

This resolution approves a three (3) year contract with Galls, LLC to supply operations uniforms, at a total cost not to exceed \$1,469,251.19.

PROPOSED RESOLUTION 2022-04: APPROVAL OF A MEMORANDUM OF UNDERSTANDING (MOU) WITH THE VILLAGE OF SILVERTON

This resolution approves a Memorandum of Understanding (MOU) with the Village of Silverton to allow SORTA staff to collaborate with the Village of Silverton to identify potential transit orientated development.

PROPOSED RESOLUTION 2022-05: APPROVAL TO PURCHASE ELECTRIC VEHICLES FOR ACCESS

This resolution approves a contract with Transportation Equipment Sales Corporation (Tesco) for the purchase of three (3) electric vehicles for Access, at a total cost not to exceed \$633,508 (\$630,658 for vehicles and a \$2,850 delivery charge).

PROPOSED RESOLUTION 2022-06: APPROVAL OF CONTRACT FOR ALTERNATOR TEST BENCH

This resolution approves a contract with Kirk's Automotive, Inc. for an alternator test bench, at a total cost not to exceed \$144,003, as the lowest responsive bid from a responsible bidder.

DISCUSSION ACTION ITEM(S):**PROPOSED RESOLUTION 2022-07: APPROVAL OF THE COLLECTIVE BARGAINING AGREEMENT (CBA)**

Mr. Hinton made a motion and Ms Black seconded the motion to approve Resolution No. 2022-07. This resolution approves the successor collective bargaining agreement for the Metro Operating Division for the period of November 1, 2020 through October 31, 2023 and authorizes and directs the CEO/General Manager or other designated representative to sign and execute said agreement with Amalgamated Transit Union Local 627.

By roll call, the SORTA Board approved the resolution.

FINANCIAL REPORTS FOR DECEMBER 2021

Ms. Resor presented the December financial reports. Total revenues were \$12.6 million, which is unfavorable to budget by \$0.1 million. Total expenses were \$16.5 million, which is favorable to budget by \$314,000 or 1.9%. Fare revenue was unfavorable to budget by (\$184,000). Ms. Resor then reviewed the contributing factors to these variances.

The Board accepted the report as presented.

YEAR IN REVIEW

The SORTA Board accepted the video as presented.

METRO ON THE MOVE REPORT

Mr. Haley provided a briefing report of Metro on the Move. The report included Metro's 2021 accomplishments; holiday festivities; Shop and Vax on Metro; recognizing Jeff Mundstock by Mass Transit as "Top 40 Under 40"; the Transit Infrastructure Signing Ceremony; and conclude his report by thanking the SORTA Board and staff for their continued hard work and effort through 2021.

The SORTA Board accepted the report as presented.

GOVERNANCE AND NOMINATING COMMITTEE

Mr. Cull stated the Governance and Nominating Committee (Ms. Black, Mr. Hinton, and Mr. Cull) recommended Kreg Keesee as the Chair and Aylson Beridon as the Vice-Chair of the SORTA Board.

Mr. Keesee asked if there were any other nominations. Hearing none, he declared the nominations closed.

Mr. Cull moved for adoption and Mr. Hinton seconded the motion. By roll call vote, the Board approved Mr. Keesee as Board Chair and Ms. Beridon as Vice Chair.

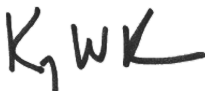
ADJOURNMENT

The meeting adjourned at 9:55 A.M.

NEXT MEETING

The next regular meeting of the SORTA Board of Trustees is scheduled for **February 15th, 2022 at 6:00 P.M.**,
the SORTA/Metro Board Room, at 525 Vine Street, Cincinnati, Ohio.

APPROVED:


Kreg Keesee
Chair, SORTA Board

ATTESTED:


Darryl Haley
CEO/General Manager/Secretary-Treasurer



EMPLOYEE RELATIONS COMMITTEE:

Bus Operations Update

February 8, 2022



AGENDA

Recruiting Update

Attrition Update

Leave of Absence

Employee Engagement Survey



Recruiting

RECRUITING STRATEGY AND PRGRAMS

- Increased Recruiting Advertising and Marketing budget
TV, Radio, Print, Billboards, etc.
- In- person Career Fairs (6)
- Community Partnership
- New Hire bonus to \$2,000
- Training Wage - \$19
- First Progression wage \$21.06
- Addition of another Recruiter
- Retiree Recruitment (pt-time)

Recruiting

Total Hires in 2021 – 187

Admin – 43 (26R/17N)

Bargaining Unit - 144

Administration - 43

Vice President Transit Operations

Director Transit Development and Innovation

Director of Ridership Development

Manager ADA & Accessible Services

External Affairs Manager

Sr. Director Procurement

Bargaining Unit

Operators - **126**

Maintenance - **18**

2021 Attrition

Total separations 2021 - 150

28 - Administrative

12 - Maintenance

110 - Operators

Job change – **11**

Long Term Sick - **18**



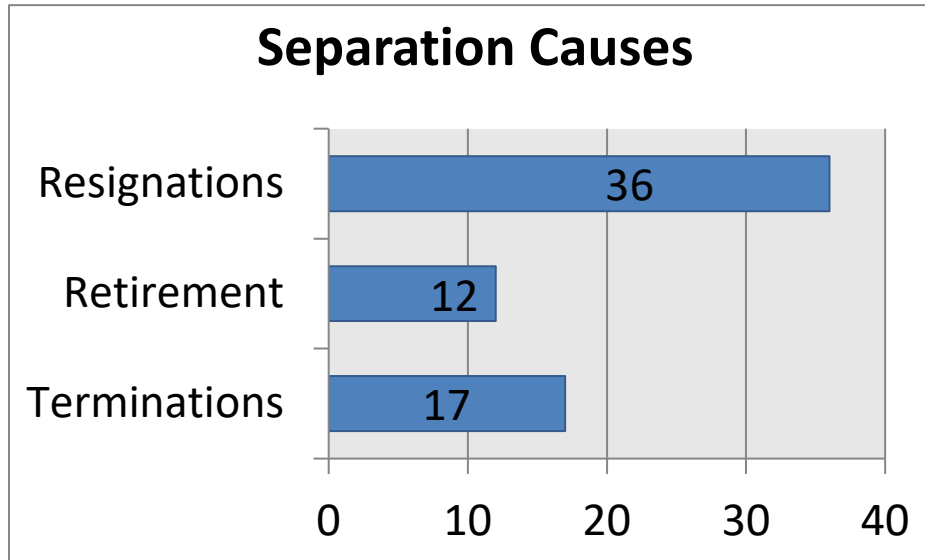
Operator Attrition

65 – Operator Separations (59%)

36 – Resignations (V)

12 – Retirements (V)

17 – Terminations (IV)



Resignations

- new job
- hours
- personal
- health
- unknown

Terminations

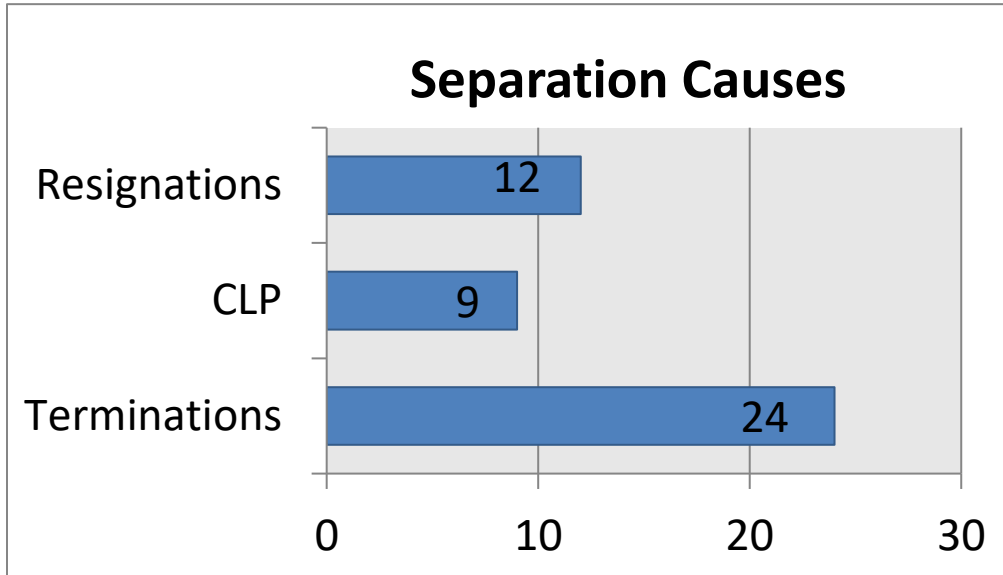
- Misconduct
- Absenteeism
- Other
- Benefits Exp
- D&A

Trainee Attrition

45 Trainee Separations (41%)

12 – Resignations (V)

33 – Terminations (IV)



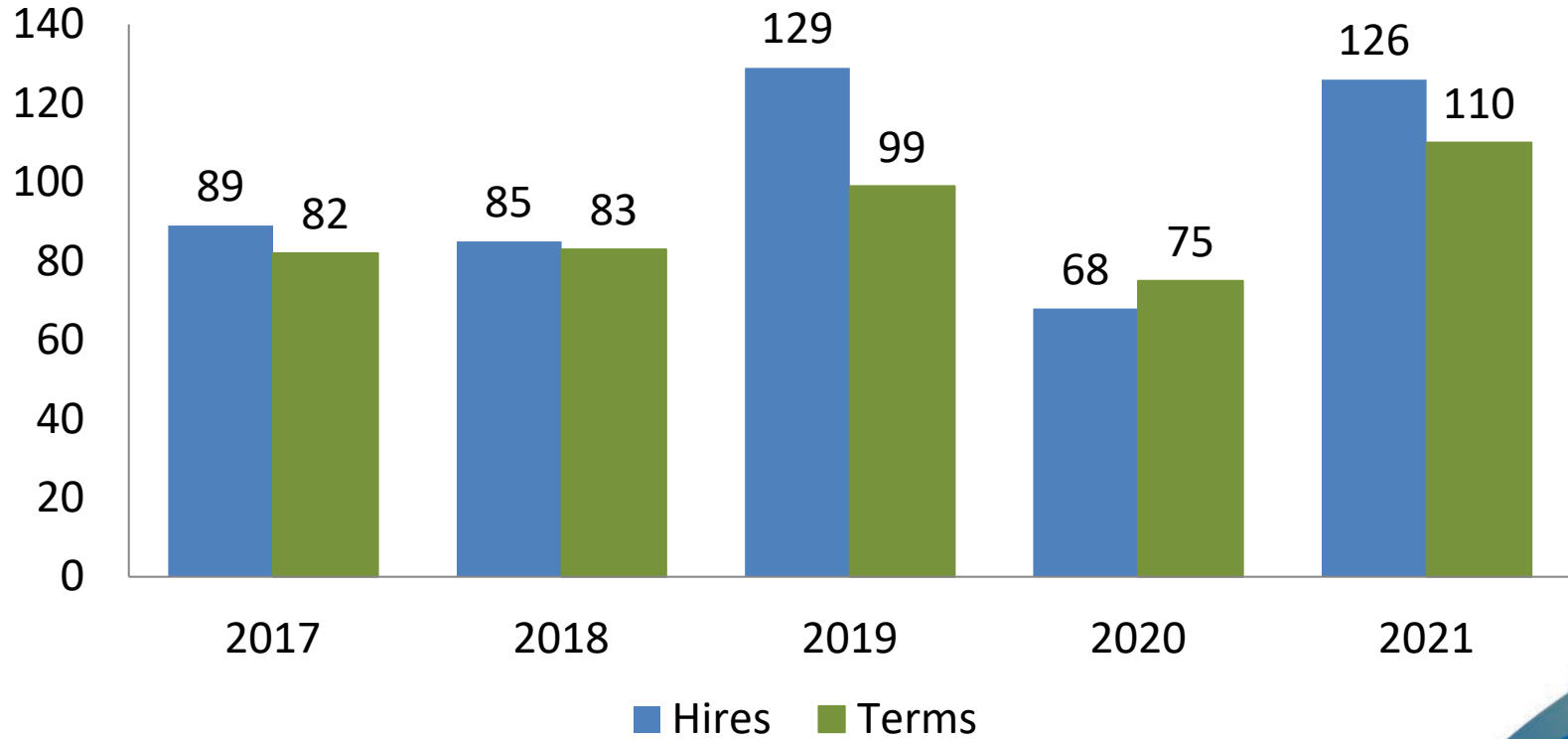
Resignations

- hours
- new job
- personal
- unknown

Terminations

- NCNS
- attendance
- unknown
- performance
- CDL

Operator Recruiting Trends



Leave of Absence

- Leave Administrator processes all employees Sick claims & STD (Admin).
- Leave Administrator partners with 3rd party providers to track other leaves.
 - FMLA claims
 - STD Claims (BU)
- FMLA leaves run concurrent with all sick related leave request (sick, STD, WC, etc.)

Sick Request

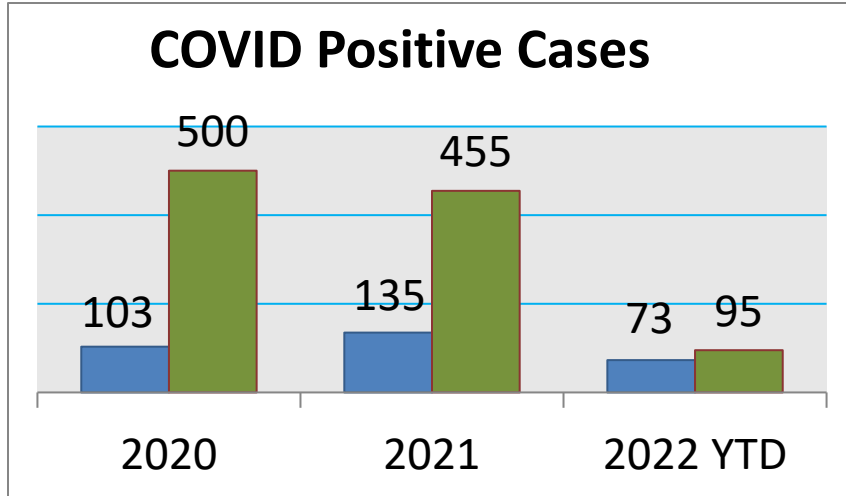
2021

- 977 Sick Claims request
 - 455 COVID related Claims

2022

- 148 Sick Claims opened
- 56 Sick Claims currently remain open
- 73 Positive COVID cases
- 18 employees currently on long term sick (>6mos)

COVID



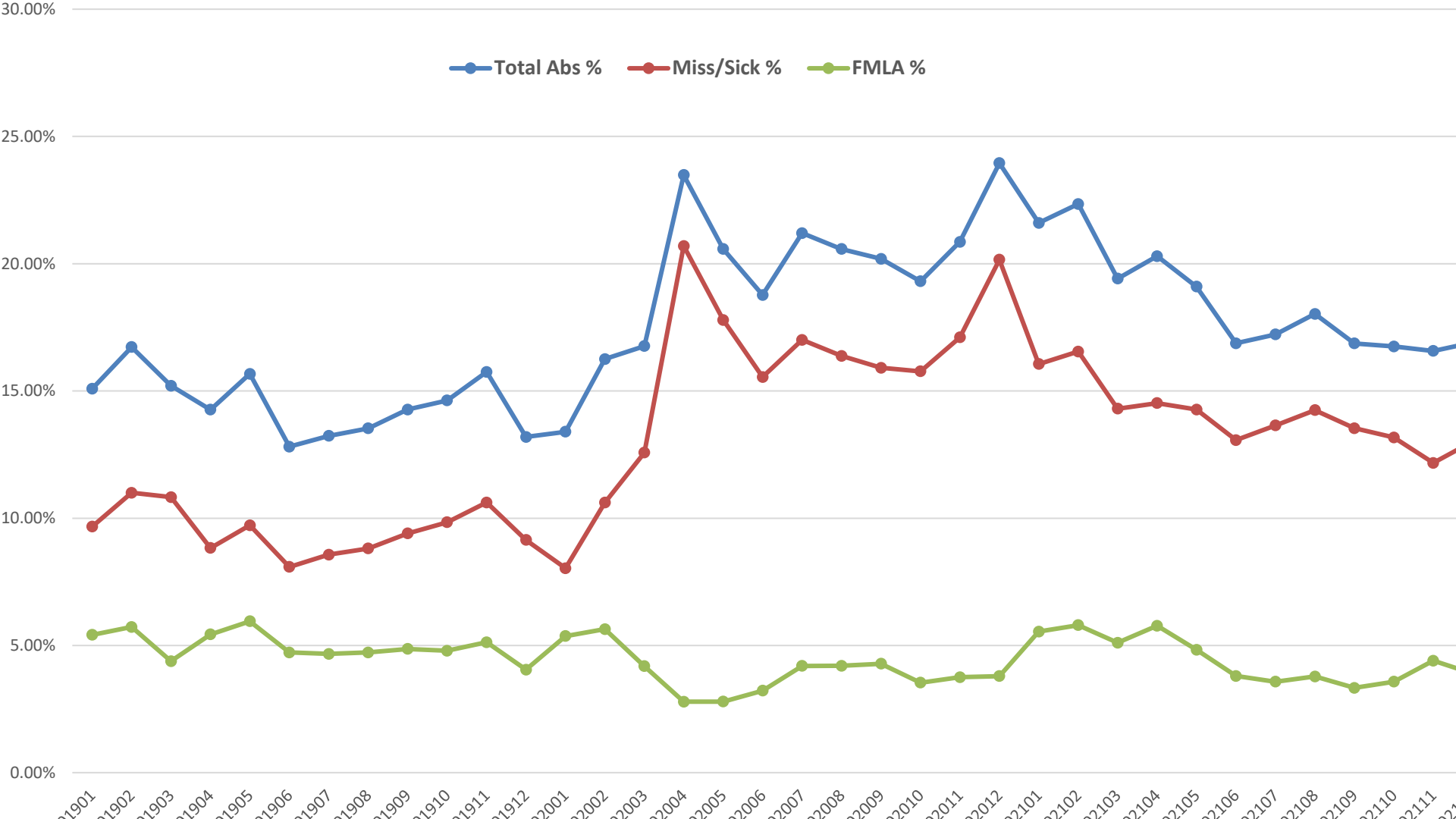
Mask provided
Hand Sanitizer
Postings
Vaccine contest
Plastic Shields
Buses sanitized
Facilities sanitized

FMLA Request

	Unique FMLA Cases	Employees with FMLA	Continuous	Intermittent	Multiple
2019	388	267	57	161	49
2020	538	328	122	83	120
2021	597	297	81	143	73

Approximately 80% of all FMLA claims are attributed to Operators





Employee Engagement Survey

- Began January 24th and ended on January 30, 2022.
- Partnered with C. Robinson & Associates firm to facilitate our employee engagement survey.
- C. Robinson and staff spent a week on property to personally encourage Metro employees to complete the survey.
- The survey was paper-based to allow all employees access and to ensure anonymity.

Employee Engagement Survey

SOUTHWEST OHIO REGIONAL TRANSIT AUTHORITY
2022 EMPLOYEE SURVEY



Please select the best response to each statement below

1 = Strongly Disagree 2 = Disagree 3 = Somewhat Agree 4 = Agree 5 = Strongly Agree

	(1) Strongly Disagree	(2) Disagree	(3) Somewhat Agree	(4) Agree	(5) Strongly Agree
1. I feel good about the work I do at SORTA.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
2. I am respected and appreciated by my peers at SORTA.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
3. SORTA provides me with the tools and resources I need to feel safe at work.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
4. I receive timely feedback that allows me to be my best at work.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
5. I have received the right tools and training to be my best at work.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
6. I am respected and appreciated by my supervisors at SORTA.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
7. I am satisfied with the training opportunities available for me at SORTA.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
8. I have a clear understanding of SORTA's vision, mission and goals.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
9. I know where to go to get the help I need to be my best at work.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
10. Teamwork is encouraged and practiced at SORTA.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
11. My supervisor provides me with timely feedback on my performance.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
12. I am aware of the Strategic Plan at SORTA.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
13. SORTA's facilities and equipment are up to date & adequate to serve the public's needs.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
14. I receive recognition for good work.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
15. We have the right Leadership Team to achieve SORTA's Vision and Mission.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
16. Overall I am satisfied working at SORTA.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

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Survey Focus

Satisfaction

Engagement

Strategic Awareness

Pandemic

Open Ended



Employee Engagement Survey

507

SURVEYS COMPLETED

Results are currently being tabulated

Employee focus groups?

Action plans developed and implemented

Questions



SOUTHWEST OHIO REGIONAL TRANSIT AUTHORITY
Monthly Financial Report
Executive Summary
January 31, 2022

SORTA's financial report for the month ending January 31, 2022 is attached.

Operating surplus before adjustments was \$0.9 million for the month. Capital Revenue was recorded to offset the operating surplus to build the Capital Reserve.

Total Revenue of \$11.7 million for the month was unfavorable to budget by \$(0.3) million or (2.9%).

Key Drivers - Total Revenue

- **Fares:** Fare revenue was unfavorable to budget by \$(141,000) or (14.7%) for the month. The unfavorable fare revenue was almost entirely due to the unfavorable ridership in both Fixed Route and Access service. The Omicron variant, which spiked in the region in January, caused many employers and/or residents to forgo their return to in-person activities and extend working from home.
- **CPS Contract:** As a result of an estimated credit of \$2.1 million due to CPS for unused passes, the CPS revenue was unfavorable to budget for the month by \$(191,000) or (39.6%). We will continue to monitor the passes for the remainder of the school year and credit CPS for the total unused passes at the end of the school year.

Total Expense of \$10.9 million was favorable to budget by \$1.2 million or 10.2% for the month.

Key Drivers - Total Expense

- **Wages & Benefits:** Favorable to budget by \$368,000 or 4.6% due to favorable wage and wage related benefits primarily from operator wages as a result of missed trips and favorable holiday wages.
- **Fuel & Lubricants:** Favorable to budget by \$163,000 or 35.4% as a result of lower miles driven compared to budget due to missed trips and favorable miles per gallon.
- **Other:** Favorable to budget \$671,000 or 23.0% due to the timing of outsourced services and training expense compared to budget.

Southwest Ohio Regional Transit Authority
2022 Profit & Loss Statement

1 Mth Ending Jan 31, 2022 (\$ In Thousands)	Month				Year to Date				
	Actual	Budget	Fav(Unfav)		Actual	Budget	Fav(Unfav)		Prior Year
Ridership									
Fixed Route	525,577	604,795	(79,218)	(13.1%)	525,577	604,795	(79,218)	(13.1%)	457,707
CPS	88,452	76,000	12,452	16.4%	88,452	76,000	12,452	16.4%	6,412
Subtotal Fixed Route	614,029	680,795	(66,766)	(9.8%)	614,029	680,795	(66,766)	(9.8%)	464,119
Access	11,682	12,726	(1,044)	(8.2%)	11,682	12,726	(1,044)	(8.2%)	7,146
Total Ridership	625,711	693,521	(67,810)	(9.8%)	625,711	693,521	(67,810)	(9.8%)	471,265
Recovery Ratio	8.6%	9.3%	(0.7%)		8.6%	9.3%	(0.7%)		9.7%
Revenue									
Metro Fares	\$ 771	\$ 910	\$ (139)	(15.3%)	\$ 771	\$ 910	\$ (139)	(15.3%)	\$ 660
Access Fares	46	48	(2)	(4.2%)	46	48	(2)	(4.2%)	30
Total Fares	817	958	(141)	(14.7%)	817	958	(141)	(14.7%)	690
CPS Contract	291	482	(191)	(39.6%)	291	482	(191)	(39.6%)	158
Other Contract Revenue	116	154	(38)	(24.7%)	116	154	(38)	(24.7%)	99
Non Transportation	120	79	41	51.9%	120	79	41	51.9%	100
County Sales Tax	8,043	8,043	-	-	8,043	8,043	-	-	7,476
Federal Subsidies	-	-	-	n/a	-	-	-	n/a	950
CRRSAA	-	-	-	n/a	-	-	-	n/a	-
ARP	2,109	2,109	-	-	2,109	2,109	-	-	-
State Subsidies	237	256	(19)	(7.4%)	237	256	(19)	(7.4%)	76
Total Revenue	11,733	12,081	(348)	(2.9%)	11,733	12,081	(348)	(2.9%)	9,549
Expenses									
Employee Wages & Benefits	7,695	8,063	368	4.6%	7,695	8,063	368	4.6%	6,619
Fuel & Lubricants	298	461	163	35.4%	298	461	163	35.4%	318
Parts & Supplies	573	602	29	4.8%	573	602	29	4.8%	486
Empowerment Fund	42	42	-	-	42	42	-	-	-
Other	2,242	2,913	671	23.0%	2,242	2,913	671	23.0%	987
Total Expenses	10,850	12,081	1,231	10.2%	10,850	12,081	1,231	10.2%	8,410
Surplus(Deficit) Before Adj	\$ 883	\$ -	\$ 883		\$ 883	\$ -	\$ 883		\$ 1,139
Capital Revenue	(883)				(883)				(1,139)
After Adjustments	\$ -	\$ -			\$ -	\$ -			\$ -
Capital									
Capital Revenue	\$ 883				\$ 883				
Capital Reserve	(883)				(883)				
Remaining Funds	\$ -				\$ -				

Southwest Ohio Regional Transit Authority



**SORTA Financial Results
January 31, 2022**

**REINVENTING
METRO!**

KEY DRIVERS ACTUAL VS BUDGET





- January sales tax revenue of \$8.0 million recorded based on UC Economic Center projection. Cash from January sales tax will be received in April. The difference between the January projected and actual receipts will impact April revenue.
- Operating reserve expense of \$1.1 million recorded to reach the budget goal to achieve two months of operating reserve by the end of 2022
- Actual open administrative positions was 22% of total budgeted positions. This vacancy percentage was flat compared to the assumption in the budget for January.

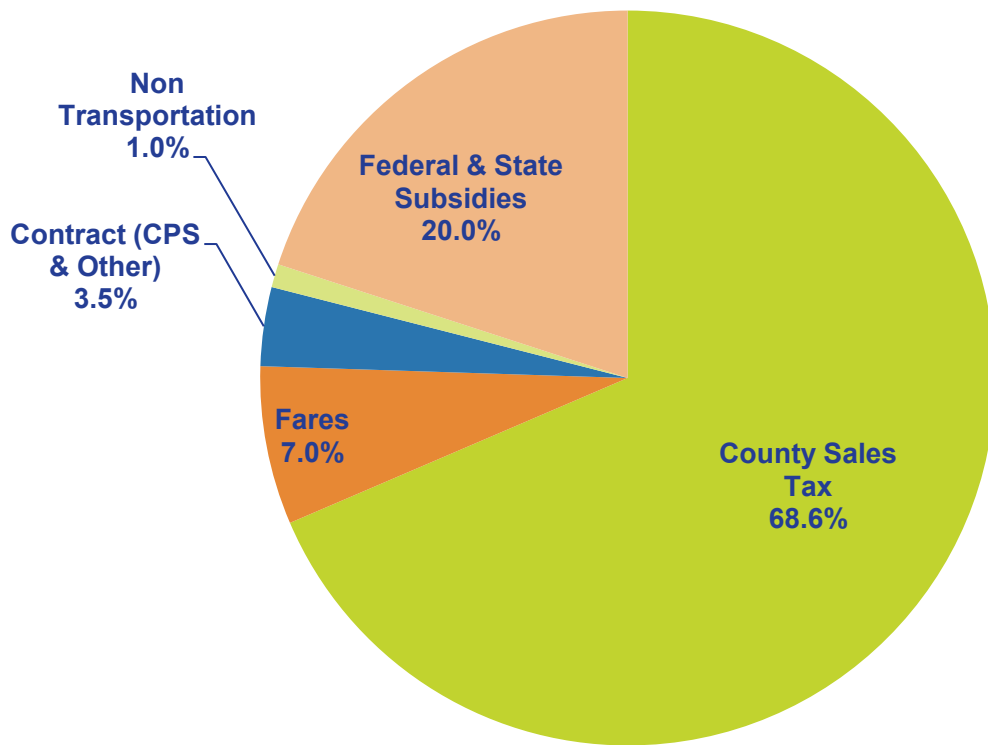


- While no change has been made to the current CPS service, a change to the total credit for unused passes was made after the budget was approved.
- CPS ridership in January was 16.4% favorable due to increased student ridership since the budget was approved.
- The projected ridership increase for Fixed Route (non-CPS) and Access was based on the trend at the time the budget was approved. The ridership trend changed as a result of the Omicron variant spike in our region when many business returned to working from home.



OPERATING REVENUE SOURCES





Total Revenue - \$11.7 million



JANUARY 2022 STATEMENT OF OPERATIONS



JANUARY 2022 STATEMENT OF OPERATIONS **\$000's**



	Month				Prior Year
	Actual	Budget	Fav(Unfav)		
Ridership					
Fixed Route	525,577	604,795	(79,218)	(13.1%)	457,707
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Total Expenses	10,850	12,081	1,231	10.2%	8,410
Surplus(Deficit) Before Adj	\$ 883	\$ -	\$ 883		\$ 1,139
Capital Revenue	(883)				(1,139)
After Adjustments	\$ -	\$ -			\$ -



February 2022

Transit Infrastructure Fund Signing Ceremony: It was great to see so many of you, along with our elected officials, community leaders and dignitaries from Washington, D.C. who joined us for the Inaugural Transit Infrastructure Fund Signing Ceremony on Thursday night. It was a great celebration and another testament to the impact investing in transit can have on our community. Another levy promise was realized with the signing of the contracts to award 22 communities with \$227 million for 30 transit-related infrastructure projects throughout Hamilton County for roads, sidewalks, and bridges.

We were excited to host the American Public Transit Association Chair Jeff Nelson earlier in the day to tour our new Northside Transit Center, along with the Queensgate facility and the Riverfront Transit Center. He praised the organization for our vision and stated that the transit community and the country had taken notice to what we are doing here in Cincinnati. Thank you to each of you for your leadership and support as we work together to Reinvent Metro.

Ohio Loves Transit Week: In partnership with the Ohio Public Transit Association and systems across Ohio, Metro will be celebrating Ohio Loves Transit Week, Feb. 14-20. I will be meeting with State representatives in Columbus on Wednesday to thank them for their continued support of Metro and to update them on the incredible improvements we've rolled out through the Reinventing Metro plan.

Celebrating Black History Month: In recognition of Black History Month, we celebrate the contributions of the many African Americans whose courage, ingenuity and hardwork has impacted and modernized public transportation. Listen to our Black History Month inspired radio spots on Radio One channels and check out our social media pages for spotlights on remarkable figures.

A handwritten signature in black ink that reads "Darryl Haley".

Darryl Haley
CEO/General Manager/ Secretary-Treasurer